was different from the one captured in Thane, what happened to the Thane Mohammad, why was he not produced? Why wasn't anyone even remotely interested in cross-checking this claim?

And how hard did the investigators try to catch the alleged masterminds, Masood Azhar, Ghazi Baba and Tariq Ahmad? The Delhi Police claims that the Srinagar Police arrested Afzal and Shaukat when they were going to meet Ghazi Baba with Mohammad's laptop and Rs 10 lakh in cash. In which case why were they nabbed before, and not followed to the rendezvous with Ghazi Baba? Why did the Srinagar Police not want to catch the suspected mastermind when they had specific information, allegedly from Afsan Guru, Shaukat's wife, about this meeting?

On 3 April 2002, Judge S.N. Dhingra asked the Delhi Police whether the Interpol had been alerted for the arrest of the three masterminds, to which a senior police officer replied that the 'matter was being looked into'. Thereafter, we hear nothing more about Interpol or any further activity to apprehend the masterminds. And apart from a few members of civil society no one—not the judges, the many security experts, the investigating agencies, the Indian intelligence agencies, Members of Parliament, journalists—thought it fit to demand a probe. In 2003, nearly two years after the Parliament attack, Ghazi Baba was killed by the BSF in a routine operation in Srinagar. One can only assume that this was done without the knowledge and coordination of the team investigating the Parliament attack, or more care would have been taken, perhaps, to capture him alive, bring him to trial and get to the truth of the conspiracy.

If I were the mastermind, would hanging Afzal deter me from planning further attacks, or would it only confirm my suspicions that India is content to leave me untouched as long as they get *somebody* to hang? The Supreme Court observed, 'The challenge to the unity, integrity and sovereignty of India by these acts of terrorists can only be compensated by giving the maximum punishment to the person who is proved to be the conspirator in this act . . .'[4] I beg to differ. Afzal is the reddest herring that has appeared before the Indian republic in a long time, and the challenge to this country's 'unity, integrity and sovereignty' would be far better met by conducting a thorough and professional probe into the Parliament attack instead of hanging a man who is so clearly the scapegoat in the whole sordid affair.